

NHID-Auth v1.0

Open Proposal: Authorization Layer for Healthcare Voice AI

Companion Specification to NHID-Clinical v1.3

Author: Brianna Baynard

Published: May 2026

License: CC BY 4.0

May 2026 — Open Proposal Status

This is a voluntary companion draft to the NHID-Clinical open proposal. It defines a minimum viable attestation format for delegated authority. No formal validation program exists yet. Infrastructure for verification is still maturing.

1. The Authorization Problem

Disclosure alone does not prove that an AI voice agent is authorized to act on behalf of a provider. Public identifiers like NPI are easy to spoof.

2. Core Principle: Identity $\neq$ Authorization

NHID-Clinical handles who is calling. NHID-Auth handles whether they are allowed to act on behalf of the named entity.

3. Authorization Attestation Requirements

A valid attestation should contain these five elements:

- Delegating Entity (e.g., Provider NPI or Payer Organization ID)
- Authorized Actor (Vendor platform ID or AI system identifier)
- Scope (e.g., claims_inquiry, eligibility_check)
- Duration (ISO 8601 start and end timestamps)
- Revocation Capability (reference ID or revocation endpoint)

4. Validation Guidance

Receivers should verify the attestation exists, the scope matches the request, it is still valid, and has not been revoked (when possible).

5. Design Intent

Minimal, portable, audit-friendly, and extensible. No cryptography required at baseline.

6. Implementation Guidance

Vendors: Generate attestation from contracts, apply least privilege, include reference ID.

Receivers: Request the attestation during the call and validate it.

7. Relationship to NHID-Clinical

Behavioral disclosure (NHID-Clinical) can be implemented immediately. Authorization verification (NHID-Auth) can be added later when partnerships are ready.

Contact

Technical Questions: help@nhid-clinical.org

Website: nhid-clinical.org

Suggested Citation

Baynard, B. (2026). NHID-Auth v1.0. nhid-clinical.org. CC BY 4.0.